

Incident Management Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Phase 2 – Requirement Analysis

1. Requirement Analysis Overview

This phase converts the project idea into measurable requirements and defines what the ServiceNow solution must do, who interacts with it and how implementation will be verified.

2. Stakeholder Requirements

Stakeholder	Key Requirement
Service Desk Agent	Create, classify, prioritize, assign, update and resolve incidents.
Level 2 Team	Receive escalated incidents with complete context.
Change Team	Create and track changes associated with incidents.
Knowledge Manager	Create, maintain and reuse troubleshooting knowledge.
IT Management	Monitor SLA status and service outcomes.

3. Functional Requirements

- Allow agents to create incidents with caller, description, service and priority information.
- Support service and service-offering association.
- Support assignment to an assignment group and individual agent.
- Support escalation to a higher support level when required.
- Support parent and child incident relationships.
- Allow change requests to be created or linked to incidents.
- Support creation and attachment of knowledge articles.
- Maintain activity history for important changes.
- Display incident-related Task SLA information.
- Require appropriate resolution information before completion.

4. Non-Functional Requirements

- Usability – common tasks should be simple for support agents.
- Reliability – records and history should remain traceable.
- Security – access should follow ServiceNow roles and permissions.
- Maintainability – configurations should be understandable and manageable.
- Performance – routine operations should respond within acceptable platform limits.

5. Business Rules: Incident state, priority and ownership should reflect the operational condition. Escalation should route work to an appropriate support team. Required changes should remain linked.

Knowledge should be reusable where appropriate and resolution should be documented before completion.

6. Data Requirements

Record	Required Information / Relationship
Incident	Caller, short description, description, priority, state, service, assignment.
Service	Service name and operational status.
Service Offering	Offering name and parent service.
Child Incident	Parent incident reference and lifecycle state.
Change Request	Change number, description and incident relationship.
Knowledge Article	Knowledge base, category, short description and article body.
Task SLA	SLA definition, timing and status.

7. Process Requirements

1. Create and classify the incident.
2. Associate the affected service and service offering.
3. Set impact, urgency and priority.
4. Assign to the appropriate support team.
5. Escalate or create child incidents when required.
6. Use or create knowledge.
7. Create or link a change request when needed.
8. Resolve with appropriate resolution notes.
9. Verify related records and SLA.
10. Validate the complete lifecycle end-to-end.

8. Acceptance Criteria

- Parent incident reaches Resolved.
- Child incident reaches Resolved when configured.
- Activity history shows key lifecycle and parent-resolution events.
- Change request is linked.
- Knowledge article is created or attached.
- Task SLA records are visible.

9. Requirement Traceability

Requirement	Validation Evidence
Lifecycle automation	Incident state and activity history
Escalation	Assignment group/user and activity changes
Change integration	Linked Change Request
Knowledge creation	Created/Attached Knowledge
Child incident	Child state and parent-resolution activity
SLA tracking	Task SLAs related list
Collaboration	Assignments, related records and activity